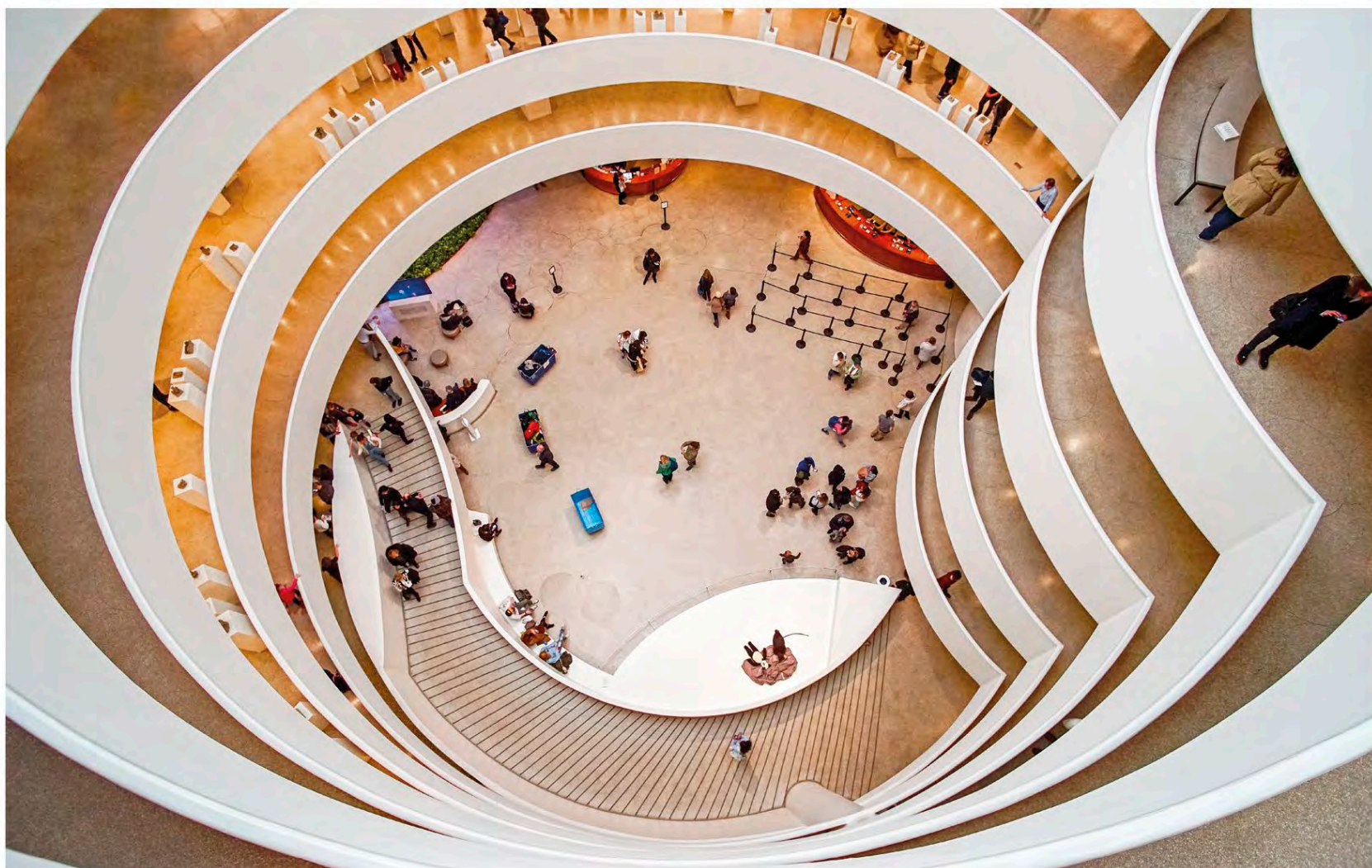
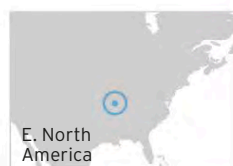




Gateway Arch

*A symbolic entrance to the western US,
built on the banks of the mighty Mississippi*



The Gateway Arch stands on the site where the inland port city of St. Louis was founded on the west bank of the Mississippi River by two French fur traders—Pierre Laclède and Auguste Chouteau—in 1764. St. Louis has long been considered the gateway for American expansion to the west, and it was here that Meriwether Lewis and William Clark set out on their famous expedition of 1804 to the Pacific Coast. The Gateway Arch was built as a monument to the city's pioneering spirit and officially dedicated to “the American people” on May 25, 1968.

Design and construction

The structure was designed in 1947 by the Finnish American architect Eero Saarinen (1910–1961), but construction was delayed because of funding and planning issues, so it did not start until almost 2 years after Saarinen's death. Built of carbon steel and concrete and coated with stainless steel, the arch is the tallest memorial in the US. A tram system inside it takes visitors up to the observation deck at the top.

▷ GATEWAY TO THE WEST

The width and the height of the Gateway Arch are the same, at 630 ft (192 m). The cross-section of each leg is an equilateral triangle that becomes smaller toward the top of the arch.

